FREE PRINTABLE CASEBOOK

3 Free Murder Mystery Puzzles

(Printable)

Three original cases. One floor plan, one clock, pure logic.
No guessing needed.

EASY · MEDIUM · HARD · SOLUTIONS INSIDE

Room & Hour

How to play

Every case is a closed world: a floor plan, three hours on the clock, a handful of suspects and one victim. Work out who was in which room at each hour and what each suspect was carrying. Then the killer gives themselves away.

1. **THE MAP.** Each room has a letter. Doors are gaps in the walls, and a staircase counts as a door. "Next door" means joined by a door or a staircase.

2. **THE CLOCK.** Each case covers three hours. At each hour, every suspect was in exactly one room. The clues only talk about those three hours.

3. **THE ONE-DOOR RULE.** From one hour to the next, a person either stayed put or walked through exactly one door.

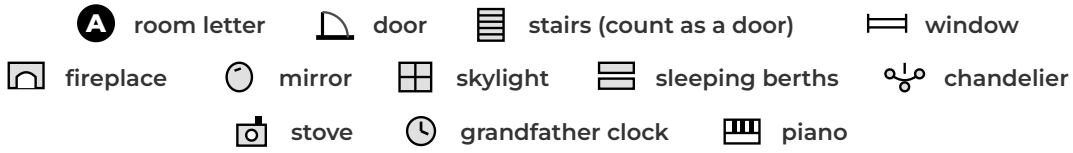
4. **THE OBJECTS.** Each suspect carried one of the listed objects all evening, and no two carried the same one. An object is always wherever its carrier is.

5. **THE WORDS.** When a clue names two people, they are two different people. "Alone" means nobody else, not even the victim, was in the room. Counts such as "exactly two suspects" count suspects only.

6. **THE KILLER.** Exactly one suspect was ever alone with the victim. That meeting was the murder: its room, its hour, and the object the killer carried.

7. **FAIR PLAY.** Every case has exactly one solution, and you can reach it by deduction alone. No guessing, ever.

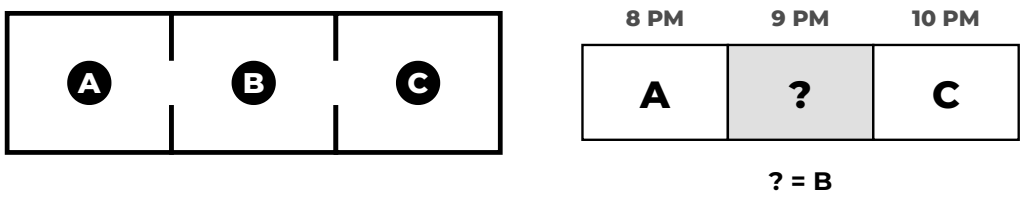
READING THE FLOOR PLAN



Windows and room features only matter when a clue mentions them. Each map shows only the symbols it uses.

How to solve a case

1. **PIN.** Some clues settle a cell outright. Circle that room letter and cross out the others in the cell.
2. **WALK THE DOORS.** A pinned cell limits the cells beside it. One hour earlier or later, the same person can only be in the same room or one door away.
3. **FOLLOW THE OBJECT.** Objects travel with their carriers. "At 10 PM, the rope was upstairs" rules the rope out for anyone who was downstairs at 10 PM. If only one person could still carry an object, it is theirs.
4. **COUNT HEADS.** If exactly two suspects were in the Hall and you have placed two there, cross the Hall out for everyone else at that hour.
5. **FIND THE MEETING.** When the timetable is full, look for the hour when a single suspect shared the victim's room. That is your killer, your room and your hour. Their object is the weapon.



Ada was in A at 8 PM and in C at 10 PM. With one door per hour, she was in B at 9 PM.

Easy cases need only the first three moves. Medium and hard cases add counting, longer chains and fewer direct clues. None of them needs a guess.

CLUE PHRASES, DECODED

"next door, neighboring": joined by a door or the stairs. A shared wall without a door does not count.

"in the room Bram had been in at 9 PM": the later room is exactly the room Bram was in at 9 PM.

"shared a room with whoever was carrying the rope": someone else had the rope, and they were in the same room.

"stayed in the same room, never moved": the same room at all three hours.

"restless": a different room from the hour before, every hour. Going back to an earlier room is allowed.

"at some point, at least one of the three hours": one hour or more.

"upstairs, backstage, the East Wing": the labeled parts of the floor plan.

CASE 1 · EASY

Candles at Thorne House

Lady Philippa Thorne turned eighty on the wettest night of the year, and she did not want a party. Her family threw one anyway. Between the soup and the fish she thanked everyone, then mentioned that she had rewritten her will that morning. The room went quiet enough to hear the rain. She spent the rest of the evening upstairs on the landing, in her favourite chair at the top of the stairs, receiving visitors like a queen. Four people had reason to climb those stairs. Each carried one thing all evening, the way people do in old houses, and only one of them was ever alone with her.

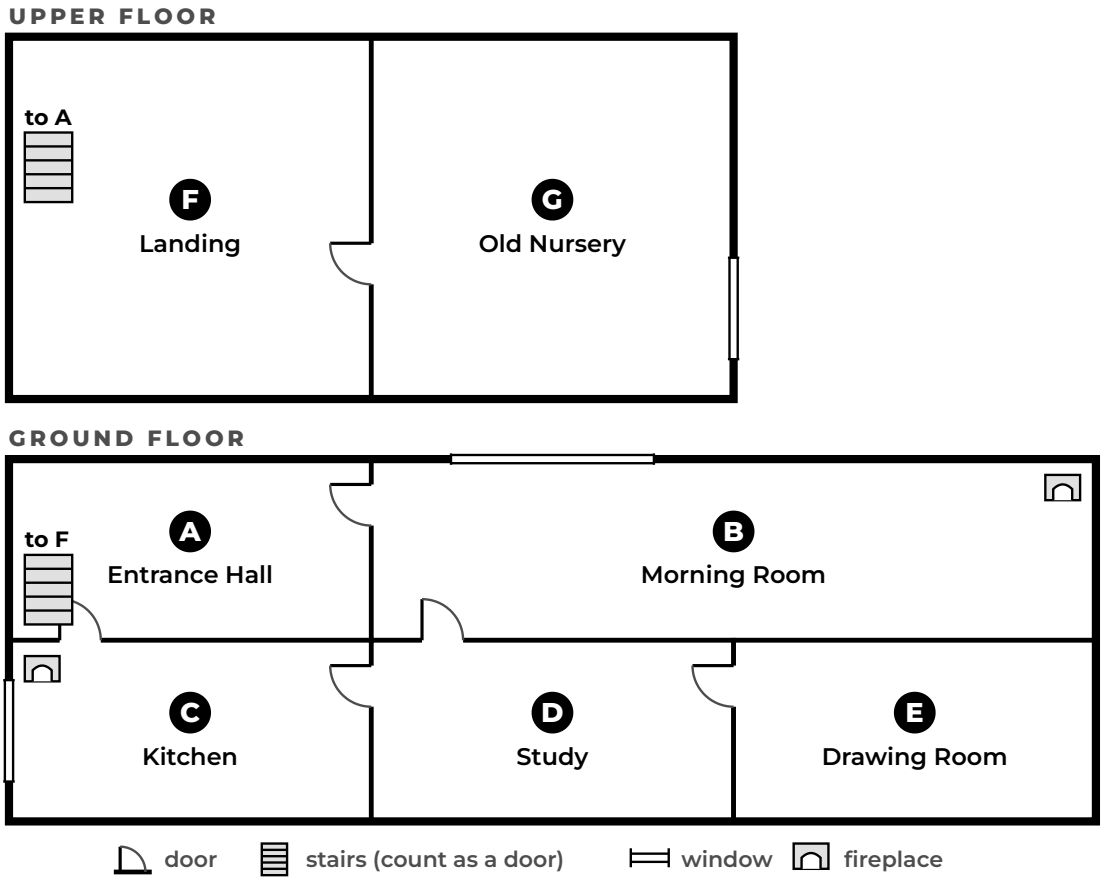
> **KNOWN FACTS** Lady Thorne was on the Landing (F) at 8 PM, 9 PM and 10 PM. The housekeeper found her there at 10:30 PM, struck down.

THE SUSPECTS

Rupert Thorne	Her grandson. Owes money to people who don't send reminders.
Agnes Pike	Housekeeper for thirty years. Knows which stair creaks.
Fabian Locke	Her solicitor. Brought the new will in a very small briefcase.
Dr. Clara Wynn	Her physician. Brought a cake and a stethoscope.

THE OBJECTS

① letter opener ② fire poker ③ walking cane ④ brass candlestick



THE CLUES

1. At 10 PM, Rupert was next door to Agnes.
2. Nobody was in the Study at 9 PM.
3. The brass candlestick was in the Entrance Hall at 8 PM.
4. At 9 PM, Rupert and Fabian were on different floors.
5. At 10 PM, no two suspects were in the same room.
6. At 8 PM, Clara was in the Drawing Room.
7. At 9 PM, Rupert was in the room Agnes had been in at 8 PM.
8. The walking cane was in the Morning Room at 10 PM.
9. Agnes spent 8 PM in the Kitchen.
10. At 10 PM, none of the suspects was upstairs.
11. Clara carried either the letter opener or the walking cane.
12. At 8 PM, Rupert and Agnes were in the same room.

NOTES

TIMETABLE

Cross out room letters as you rule them out. Circle the one that is left.

	8 PM	9 PM	10 PM	OBJECT
Lady Thorne VICTIM	**F**	**F**	**F**	**—**
Rupert	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	1 2 3 4
Agnes	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	1 2 3 4
Fabian	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	1 2 3 4
Clara	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	1 2 3 4

Who was alone with Lady Thorne, where, when, and carrying what?

KILLER _____ **ROOM** _____ **HOUR** _____ **WEAPON** _____

CASE 2 · MEDIUM

The Bar Car Never Closes

The Danube Night Ferry is a train, not a boat, and its bar car never closes. Vera Lusk, a wine importer with a famously long memory, took the corner table at eleven and announced that she would be naming names in her memoir. Then she ordered a bottle of something she could not pronounce. The bartender went off duty soon after, and the car went quiet as the train climbed into the mountains. Hours later a passenger looking for a nightcap found her slumped at the corner table, struck down long before. Five travellers on the train had been in her memoir. Each carried one thing all night.

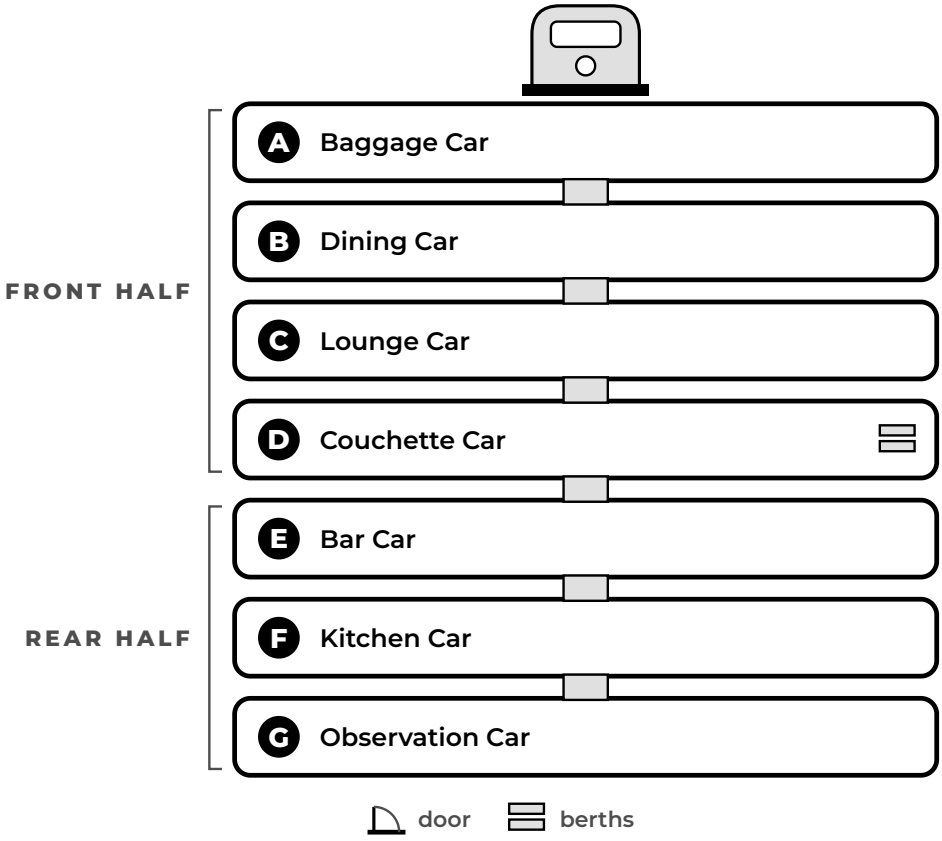
> **KNOWN FACTS** Vera was in the Bar Car (E) at 11 PM, midnight and 1 AM. A passenger found her in the Bar Car at 1:30 AM.

THE SUSPECTS

Florian Becker	Former business partner. Speaks well of her, which is suspicious.
Gisela Marr	Night porter. Has seen everything twice and reported none of it.
Hector Vamvakas	Retired diplomat. Was in chapter four.
Juno Achebe	Memoir ghostwriter. Knows every name in the book.
Sylvie Duret	Wine critic. Once called Vera's best vintage 'brave'.

THE OBJECTS

① conductor's lamp ② spanner ③ hip flask ④ silk tie ⑤ umbrella



THE CLUES

1. Sylvie stayed in the same car all evening.
2. At midnight, nobody was with Vera.
3. At midnight, Florian and Juno were in the same car.
4. The umbrella was in the Kitchen Car at midnight.
5. Nobody was in the Couchette Car at 11 PM.
6. Hector carried either the spanner or the silk tie.
7. At midnight, Hector and Sylvie were in neighboring cars.
8. At 1 AM, Florian was in a car with sleeping berths.
9. At midnight, Gisela was in the car Florian had been in at 11 PM.
10. The hip flask never moved: it spent the whole evening in one car.
11. Hector was restless: at every hour, a different car from the hour before.
12. At 1 AM, Juno shared a car with someone else who was carrying the spanner.
13. Juno was never in the Lounge Car.

NOTES

TIMETABLE

Cross out room letters as you rule them out. Circle the one that is left.

	11 PM	MIDNIGHT	1 AM	OBJECT
Vera VICTIM	**E**	**E**	**E**	**—**
Florian	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	1 2 3 4 5
Gisela	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	1 2 3 4 5
Hector	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	1 2 3 4 5
Juno	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	1 2 3 4 5
Sylvie	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	A B C D E F G	1 2 3 4 5

Who was alone with Vera, where, when, and carrying what?

KILLER _____ **ROOM** _____ **HOUR** _____ **WEAPON** _____

CASE 3 · HARD

The Forger's Ledger

Dr. Harriet Kemble had been the Pemberton's curator for six months, and in that time she had found nine forgeries on its walls. Tomorrow she planned to name the tenth, and the person who had sold all ten to the museum. She stayed late to finish her report, shut in her office with the ledger of acquisitions, and told the night staff not to disturb her. They did not. When her light was still burning near midnight, the guard looked in and found her at her desk, struck down hours before. The ledger had gone. Five people were in the building after closing, and one of them had been alone with her.

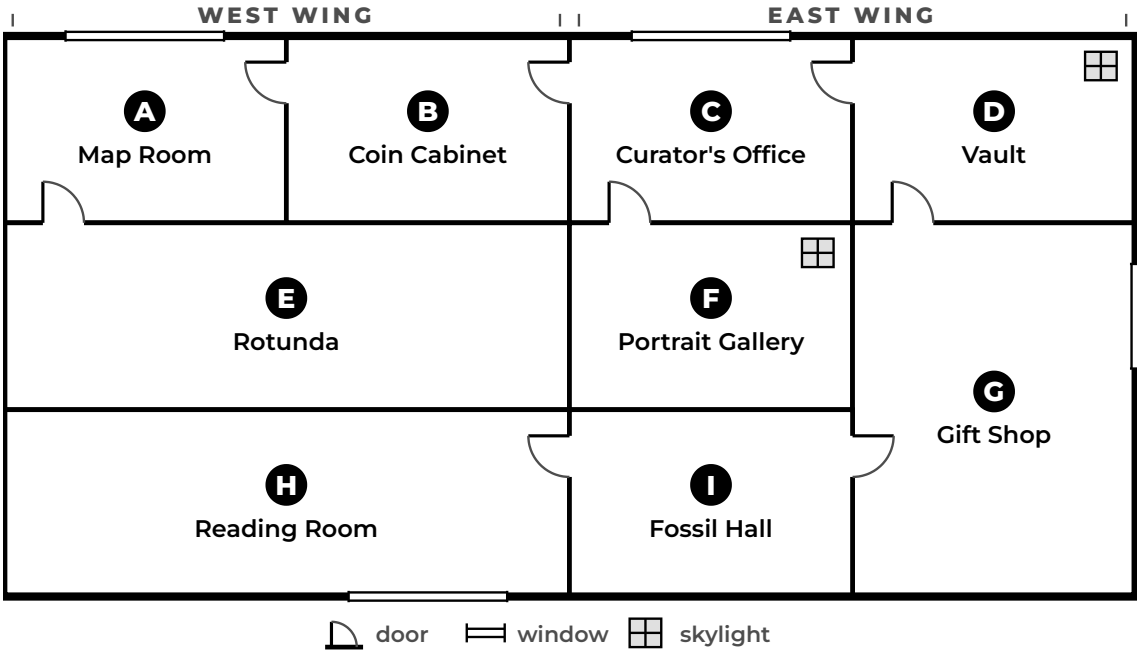
> **KNOWN FACTS** Dr. Kemble was in the Curator's Office (C) at 9 PM, 10 PM and 11 PM. The guard found her in the Curator's Office at 11:30 PM.

THE SUSPECTS

Aurelio Fenn	Art dealer. Sold the museum most of its recent acquisitions.
Bridget Callow	Conservator. Can spot a fake, or make one.
Kenneth Lamb	Trustee. Approved every purchase without looking.
Delia Mortimer	Archivist. Kept a copy of the ledger, she says.
Silas Morrow	Director. Hired her to find nothing.

THE OBJECTS

① brass telescope ② magnifying glass ③ replica scepter ④ chisel ⑤ snuffbox



THE CLUES

1. At 9 PM, Aurelio was in a room with a window.
2. At 10 PM, Delia shared a room with someone else who was carrying the magnifying glass.
3. At 11 PM, Delia was in the West Wing.
4. The snuffbox never moved: it spent the whole evening in one room.
5. At 10 PM, Bridget and Kenneth were in neighboring rooms.
6. At 9 PM, the brass telescope was in a room without a window.
7. Neither Bridget nor Delia carried the snuffbox.
8. The chisel was in the Fossil Hall at 9 PM.
9. Aurelio stayed in the East Wing all evening.
10. The brass telescope was in the Map Room at 11 PM.
11. At 11 PM, Dr. Kemble had no company.
12. At 11 PM, nobody was in the Gift Shop.
13. At 10 PM, the snuffbox was in the Coin Cabinet.
14. Nobody was in the Portrait Gallery at 10 PM.
15. At 10 PM, Silas was in a room with a skylight.
16. Bridget and Kenneth were never in the same room.
17. At some point in the evening, Silas was in the Curator's Office.

NOTES

TIMETABLE

Cross out room letters as you rule them out. Circle the one that is left.

	9 PM	10 PM	11 PM	OBJECT
Dr. Kemble VICTIM	**C**	**C**	**C**	**—**
Aurelio	A B C D E F G H I	A B C D E F G H I	A B C D E F G H I	1 2 3 4 5
Bridget	A B C D E F G H I	A B C D E F G H I	A B C D E F G H I	1 2 3 4 5
Kenneth	A B C D E F G H I	A B C D E F G H I	A B C D E F G H I	1 2 3 4 5
Delia	A B C D E F G H I	A B C D E F G H I	A B C D E F G H I	1 2 3 4 5
Silas	A B C D E F G H I	A B C D E F G H I	A B C D E F G H I	1 2 3 4 5

Who was alone with Dr. Kemble, where, when, and carrying what?

KILLER _____ **ROOM** _____ **HOUR** _____ **WEAPON** _____

Solutions

Spoilers from here on. Each page shows the answer and the solved timetable.

Candles at Thorne House

THE ANSWER

Fabian Locke killed Lady Philippa Thorne on the Landing (F) at 9 PM with the brass candlestick.

	8 PM	9 PM	10 PM	OBJECT
Rupert	**C** Kitchen	**C** Kitchen	**D** Study	fire poker
Agnes	**C** Kitchen	**A** Entrance Hall	**B** Morning Room	walking cane
Fabian	**A** Entrance Hall	**F** Landing	**A** Entrance Hall	brass candlestick
Clara	**E** Drawing Room	**E** Drawing Room	**E** Drawing Room	letter opener

HOW TO CRACK IT

1. Clue 6: Clara was in the Drawing Room (E) at 8 PM.
2. Clue 9: Agnes was in the Kitchen (C) at 8 PM.
3. Clue 7 (with clue 2): Rupert was in the Kitchen (C) at 9 PM.
4. Clue 12: Rupert was in the Kitchen (C) at 8 PM.
5. The One-Door Rule (with clue 2): Clara was in the Drawing Room (E) at 9 PM.
6. Clue 8 (with clue 11): Clara carried the letter opener.
7. Every other object is accounted for, so Rupert carried the fire poker.
8. Every other object is accounted for, so Agnes carried the walking cane.
9. Every other object is accounted for, so Fabian carried the brass candlestick.
10. Clue 3: Fabian was in the Entrance Hall (A) at 8 PM.
11. Clue 8 (with clue 10): Agnes was in the Morning Room (B) at 10 PM.
12. The One-Door Rule (with clues 2 and 4): Agnes was in the Entrance Hall (A) at 9 PM; Fabian was on the Landing (F) at 9 PM.
13. The One-Door Rule (with clues 5 and 10): Fabian was in the Entrance Hall (A) at 10 PM.
14. Clue 5 (with clues 1 and 10 plus the One-Door Rule): Rupert was in the Study (D) at 10 PM.
15. Clue 5 (with clue 10 plus the One-Door Rule): Clara was in the Drawing Room (E) at 10 PM.
16. **Only Fabian was ever alone with Lady Thorne: on the Landing at 9 PM, carrying the brass candlestick.**

The Bar Car Never Closes

THE ANSWER

Juno Achebe killed Vera Lusk in the Bar Car (E) at 11 PM with the conductor's lamp.

	11 PM	MIDNIGHT	1 AM	OBJECT
Florian	**C** Lounge Car	**D** Couchette Car	**D** Couchette Car	spanner
Gisela	**C** Lounge Car	**C** Lounge Car	**C** Lounge Car	hip flask
Hector	**F** Kitchen Car	**G** Observation Car	**F** Kitchen Car	silk tie
Juno	**E** Bar Car	**D** Couchette Car	**D** Couchette Car	conductor's lamp
Sylvie	**F** Kitchen Car	**F** Kitchen Car	**F** Kitchen Car	umbrella

HOW TO CRACK IT

1. Clue 8: Florian was in the Couchette Car (D) at 1 AM.
2. The One-Door Rule (with clues 2 and 3): Florian was in the Couchette Car (D) at midnight.
3. Clue 3 (with clues 2 and 13): Juno was in the Couchette Car (D) at midnight.
4. The One-Door Rule (with clues 5, 9 and 13): Florian was in the Lounge Car (C) at 11 PM; Juno was in the Bar Car (E) at 11 PM.
5. Clue 9 (with clue 2): Gisela was in the Lounge Car (C) at midnight.
6. Clues 4 and 6 (with clues 3 and 9 plus the One-Door Rule) rule everyone else out for the umbrella, so Sylvie carried it.
7. Clue 4 (with clues 1 and 2): Sylvie was in the Kitchen Car (F) at midnight.
8. Clue 1 (with clue 5): Sylvie was in the Kitchen Car (F) at 11 PM and 1 AM.
9. Clue 7 (with clue 2): Hector was in the Observation Car (G) at midnight.
10. The One-Door Rule (with clues 5 and 11): Hector was in the Kitchen Car (F) at 11 PM and 1 AM.
11. Clues 6 and 10 plus the only possible owner rule everyone else out for the hip flask, so Gisela carried it.
12. Clue 10 (with clue 5 plus the One-Door Rule): Gisela was in the Lounge Car (C) at 11 PM and 1 AM.
13. Clue 12 (with clue 6): Hector carried the silk tie.
14. Every other object is accounted for, so Juno carried the conductor's lamp.
15. Every other object is accounted for, so Florian carried the spanner.
16. Clue 12 (with clue 13 plus the One-Door Rule): Juno was in the Couchette Car (D) at 1 AM.
17. **Only Juno was ever alone with Vera: in the Bar Car at 11 PM, carrying the conductor's lamp.**

The Forger's Ledger

THE ANSWER

Silas Morrow killed Dr. Harriet Kemble in the Curator's Office (C) at 9 PM with the replica scepter.

	9 PM	10 PM	11 PM	OBJECT
Aurelio	**G** Gift Shop	**I** Fossil Hall	**I** Fossil Hall	magnifying glass
Bridget	**E** Rotunda	**A** Map Room	**A** Map Room	brass telescope
Kenneth	**B** Coin Cabinet	**B** Coin Cabinet	**B** Coin Cabinet	snuffbox
Delia	**I** Fossil Hall	**I** Fossil Hall	**H** Reading Room	chisel
Silas	**C** Curator's Office	**D** Vault	**D** Vault	replica scepter

HOW TO CRACK IT

1. Clue 15 (with clue 14): Silas was in the Vault (D) at 10 PM.
2. The One-Door Rule (with clues 11 and 12): Silas was in the Vault (D) at 11 PM.
3. Clues 4, 7 and 13 (with clue 15) rule everyone else out for the snuffbox, so Kenneth carried it.
4. Clue 13 (with clues 4 and 14): Kenneth was in the Coin Cabinet (B) at 10 PM.
5. Clue 4 (with clues 11 and 12): Kenneth was in the Coin Cabinet (B) at 9 PM and 11 PM.
6. Clue 8 plus the only possible owner (with clue 1 plus the One-Door Rule) rule everyone else out for the chisel, so Delia carried it.
7. Clue 8: Delia was in the Fossil Hall (I) at 9 PM.
8. The One-Door Rule (with clue 3): Delia was in the Reading Room (H) at 11 PM.
9. Clues 6 and 10 plus the only possible owner (with clue 1 plus the One-Door Rule) rule everyone else out for the brass telescope, so Bridget carried it.
10. Clue 10 (with clues 12 and 16 plus the One-Door Rule): Bridget was in the Map Room (A) at 11 PM.
11. The One-Door Rule (with clues 5 and 14): Bridget was in the Map Room (A) at 10 PM.
12. The One-Door Rule (with clues 6 and 16): Bridget was in the Rotunda (E) at 9 PM.
13. Clue 2 (with clues 8, 10 and 13): Silas carried the replica scepter.
14. Every other object is accounted for, so Aurelio carried the magnifying glass.
15. Clue 2 (with clues 9 and 14 plus the One-Door Rule): Aurelio and Delia were in the Fossil Hall (I) at 10 PM.
16. The One-Door Rule (with clues 9, 11 and 12): Aurelio was in the Gift Shop (G) at 9 PM; Aurelio was in the Fossil Hall (I) at 11 PM.
17. Clue 17 (with the One-Door Rule): Silas was in the Curator's Office (C) at 9 PM.
18. **Only Silas was ever alone with Dr. Kemble: in the Curator's Office at 9 PM, carrying the replica scepter.**

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